

and it has almost all the features that CD&DVD Maker has. RecordNow! and Inter-Video's Disc Master were left behind in the race.

Our winner by a very small margin of 1.5 points is Easy Media Creator 8. That doesn't mean Nero users should switch right away! The winner scores over Nero for its features and performance alone; Nero has a few extra bundled utilities, and most importantly, it is much easier to use.

Easy Media Creator wins in the performance department by a mammoth margin, and we've said earlier, you can run other applications without the fear of ending up with a corrupt disc.

BURNING SOFTWARE FOR LINUX

Most power users of Linux distributions are aware of and use the command-based CD burning utility. Newbies to Linux are not aware of this feature, and even if they are, not many know how to use it.

The command is "cdrecord", and you can do a "man cdrecord" to figure out how to use it. We've covered how to use this command in the *Tips & Tricks* section in this issue.

For now, we look at how two of the best CD/DVD burning software fare.

Many software are available on the Internet for burning CDs and DVDs, but they either fail with dependencies during installation, or they use the inbuilt cdrecord and mkisofs commands (the GUI front-ends). Therefore, we take a look at the popular K3b and the challenger, NeroLinux.

Ahead Software NeroLinux 2.0.0.4

Nero is a very popular software for Windows. Ahead also introduced a version for Linux some time ago,

but that didn't gain as much popularity as was expected. This could have been because it is a *licensed* software that you needed to buy for using on a *free* operating system! However, you were allowed to download and install the trial version, which has no feature limitations. The same is the case with the latest version of Nero for Linux, NeroLinux 2.0.0.4.

Features

If you've used Nero on Windows and happily installed the Linux version, it'll come as sad news that NeroLinux is not as feature-rich as its Windows counterpart. It can't even burn an audio CD. It can write data CDs and DVDs, CD/DVD images, and create bootable CDs and DVDs. Additional burn features include multi-session, overburning, and drag-and-drop. It can also create images of CDs and DVDs.

Ease Of Use

Installing applications on a Linux box is not straightforward, and lately, with all the changes that Linux has undergone, it has become all the more difficult. Considering this, Nero has made life easier, especially for those new to Linux.

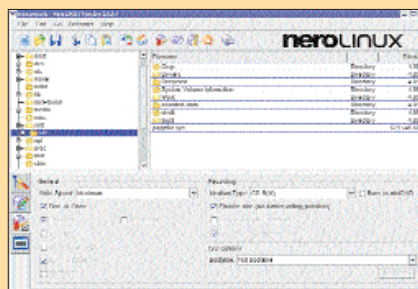
Nero has compiled the software in two popular packages - DPKG for Debian (also Knoppix and Ubuntu) users, and RPM for Red Hat/Fedora (SuSe, Mandrake, and many more based on these).

Installing NeroLinux is easy. All you need to know is the command, and of course, the serial key; remember, this is a licensed software, not freeware. The latest trial version will work till the end of January. Ahead might extend this period or come up with a newer package!

We downloaded the RPM package, which is 10 MB large. Open the Konsole or Gnome terminal to run the following command:

```
#rpm -ivh nerolinux-2.0.0.4-x86.rpm
```

You may have to switch to root user if you are not logged in as one. You may need to reboot the machine to finish the installation. On logging back in, you'll see that Nero comes under Hat (Start Menu button, RedHat) > Sound and Video > NeroLinux.



NeroLinux-burn - The interface of NeroLinux is mediocre as compared to both Nero-Windows and K3b

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